



Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

What's best for you?



## Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's backgrounds in a wider variety of communicative situations.

## Can Do Statements

- I can talk about decision-making.
- I can organize points in an argument.
- I can speculate about things, people and events.

## Ask your partner:

- When were you impulsive? What happened?
- Which situations require quick decision-making?
- Which situations benefit from considering all options slowly?

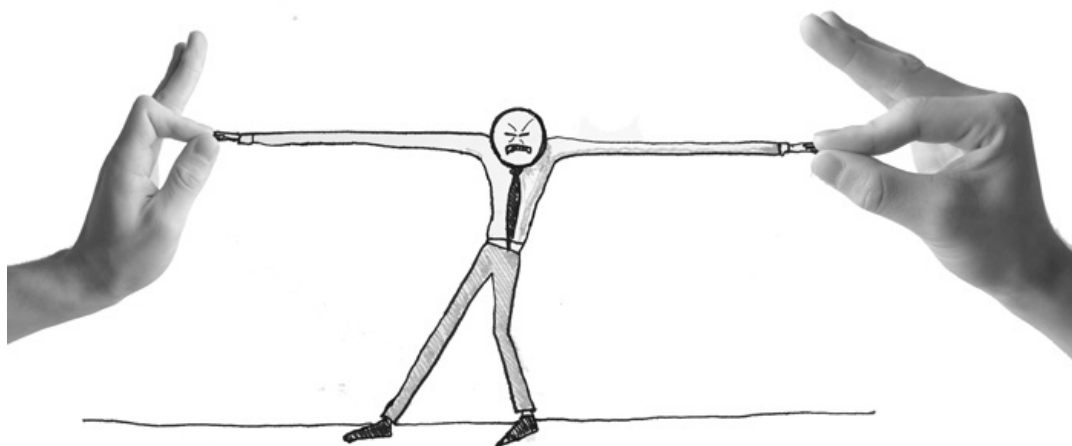




## Let's Explore!

Vanessa plays the **"devil's advocate"**\*.

\* A "devil's advocate" is a person who argues against a cause or position either for the sake of argument or to help determine its validity.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

- Vanessa:** Sally, going back to school is a big decision for you to make. You really need to take some time to determine what's best for you. Don't jump the gun.
- Sally:** Oh I know! I definitely need to evaluate the benefits and the costs of going back to school.
- Vanessa:** You might be being a little impulsive, so let's think this over together.
- Sally:** Okay. Thanks Vanessa! It could help to have someone to bounce ideas off of.
- Vanessa:** You already have a great job as a writer. You're not supposed to give up a good career.
- Sally:** On the other hand, sometimes change is good.
- Vanessa:** That's true. However, it might be best to stick with what you're good at.
- Sally:** Yeah, maybe. Even so, doing the same thing all the time can get stale. Doing something different could breathe life into my work.
- Vanessa:** That's true. All the same, you could start studying something new and discover that you don't really like it. You might waste a lot of time and money. On top of that, studying might take up so much of your time that you can't see your friends.
- Sally:** Vanessa! You are supposed to be more supportive! Why are you being so disagreeable?
- Vanessa:** Don't worry Sally. I'm just playing the devil's advocate. You know I'll support any decision you make. Finish up your coffee. Let's go for a stroll.





## Let's Practice!

Sally talks to Vanessa about going back to school.

*Instructions: Read the dialogue story again and answer the questions by circling the correct answer.*

1. What is Vanessa's first reaction towards Sally's idea about going back to school?
  - a) She is sure she should not go back
  - b) She thinks Sally is being too impulsive
  - c) She is encouraging Sally to do so
2. Sally wanted to talk to Vanessa about her idea because ...
  - a) she is sure Vanessa will be supportive.
  - b) she needs help to figure out the best option.
  - c) she is considering dropping out of school.
3. Vanessa tells Sally she is not supposed to...
  - a) give up her dreams.
  - b) give up her writing.
  - c) give up going to school.
4. One of the reasons why Sally wants to go back to school is ....
  - a) to be able to do something new.
  - b) to see her friends more often at school.
  - c) to do something stale.
5. Sally thinks that Vanessa is ...
  - a) not understanding her.
  - b) playing the devil's advocate.
  - c) not being supportive.



## Let's Practice!

When to use discourse markers?

*Instructions: Read the words and clasify them by writing them in the correct category.*

- |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• in addition</li> <li>• even so</li> <li>• however</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• on the other hand</li> <li>• on top of that</li> <li>• in fact</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• moreover</li> <li>• what is more</li> <li>• despite the fact that</li> </ul> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| Discourse markers for making a contrast | Discourse markers for adding information |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
|                                         |                                          |





## Extension Activity

Research the term "the devil's advocate".

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- On the Internet, research the term "the devil's advocate."
- Make notes about the history of this term, where it was first used and how we use it today.
- Look for any other expressions that have the same meaning, either in English or in your language.
- Present the information that you found to your class or a group.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about decision-making.

☐
☐

I speculate about things, people and events.

☐
☐

I research and make notes.

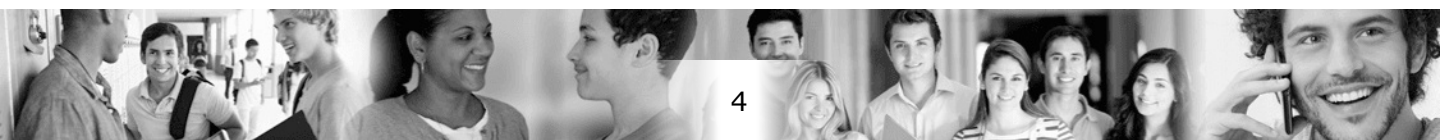
☐
☐

I present information to a group.

☐
☐


## Target Words

- to determine** (verb): to make a decision about what is best  
e.g. You really need to take some time to determine what's best for you.
- impulsive** (adjective): inclined to act without thinking about the consequences  
e.g. You might be being a little impulsive, so let's think this over together.
- to bounce ideas off** (expression): to discuss an idea with someone in order to get another perspective  
e.g. It could help to have someone to bounce ideas off of.
- stale** (adjective): boring and no longer interesting  
e.g. Doing the same thing all the time can get stale.
- supportive** (adjective): helpful and encouraging, usually during a difficult situation  
e.g. You are supposed to be more supportive! Why are you being so disagreeable?
- to breathe life into something** (expression): to improve something with new ideas and energy  
e.g. Doing something different could breathe life into my work.
- stroll** (noun): a slow, pleasurable walk  
e.g. Finish up your coffee. Let's go for a stroll.
- to jump the gun** (expression): to say or do something too soon without giving it enough thought  
e.g. You really need to take some time to determine what's best for you. Don't jump the gun.





## Learning Points

### Organizing Points in an Argument

You use words or phrases to organize ideas in a piece of writing.

Discourse markers show how ideas are connected. They usually come at the beginning of a sentence.

Discourse markers can show a **connection** to what the writer is saying and what was just written. They can also show what the writer's **opinion** is about what is being discussed.

| Discourse Marker         | Meaning                    |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| <i>All the same</i>      | Despite what has been said |
| <i>Even so</i>           | Despite what has been said |
| <i>On top of that</i>    | Adding                     |
| <i>On the other hand</i> | Contrasting two arguments  |

#### Examples:

- *On the other hand, sometimes change is good.*
- *Even so, doing the same thing all the time can get stale.*
- *That's true. All the same, you could start studying something new.*
- *On top of that, studying might take up so much of your time that you can't see your friends.*





## Learning Points

### Modal Verbs for Speculating

When you speculate about something, you are making a guess based on what you know about the situation.

You can show you are speculating about something by using a modal, like *must*, *might*, *may* or *could*.

The modal verb is followed by the main verb in the base form. You do not use "to". Do not add "ing", "ed", or "s" to the verb.

Example:

*I think you **may be able to help** me.*

These are formal structures.

#### Examples:

- *You might be being a little impulsive, so let's think this over together.*
- *It could help to have someone to bounce ideas off of.*
- *However, it might be best to stick with what you're good at.*
- *Doing something different could breathe life into my work.*

